



# Educational review of preschool teacher music curriculum at Southwest University

Peng Lyu<sup>a</sup> | Peerapong Sensai<sup>b</sup> | Khomkrich Karin<sup>a</sup>

<sup>a</sup>College of Music, Mahasarakham University, Maha Sarakham, Thailand.

<sup>b</sup>Faculty of Fine-Applied Arts and Cultural Science, Mahasarakham University, Maha Sarakham, Thailand.

**Abstract** Music education is crucial for nurturing preschool-aged children's development, as it aids in their cognitive, emotional, and social skills. Southwest University in China is one of the leading institutions in teacher education and offers dedicated courses on music education for preschool teacher training; however, its practicality is still under scrutiny. This study aims to provide a comprehensive evaluation of the music instruction offered in the context of preschool educator preparation at Southwest University. Conducted from April 2023 to May 2025, the research utilized a mixed-methods approach that included curriculum document analysis, structured interviews with nine key informants, and survey data from 110 participating students and instructors. From the analysis, the curriculum developed from aesthetic and praxial music education theory was found to contain an imbalanced emphasis on theoretical knowledge, with insufficient attention to hands-on application, cultural diversity, and digital competency. Many students reported that theoretical content was disconnected from practice and challenging to translate into effective classroom instruction, especially given limited opportunities for real-world teaching experience. Interview findings also revealed a general lack of confidence in implementing music instruction aligned with the developmental needs of young children. Feedback strongly supported the implementation of an applied pedagogical framework that integrates formative assessment, collaborative teaching strategies, and culturally responsive practices. The study concludes that curriculum reform is necessary to better align theoretical instruction with practical application, enhance the use of educational technology, and improve teacher preparedness for diverse learning environments. Future recommendations include interdisciplinary research, longitudinal impact studies, and comparative analysis across institutions. The findings contribute to enhancing the effectiveness of music education in early childhood teaching programs and aligning it more closely with contemporary classroom demands.

**Keywords:** early childhood instruction, music teaching strategies, practical pedagogy, teacher preparation programs, educational innovation

## 1. Introduction

In early childhood education, music is an invaluable resource for the development of young children, which facilitates emotional, cognitive, communicative, and social growth (Mugaya, 2022; Music, 2024; Wu et al., 2023). Consequently, music education is now considered a fundamental component of preschool education across the globe. In teacher training programs, providing music as a fundamental course not only fulfills pedagogical needs but also represents a culturally and developmentally responsible action (Partti et al., 2021; Shlenova et al., 2025; Wang et al., 2024). With Southwest University being one of the frontrunners of integrating music education into professional teacher training, it has become a pioneer regionally and nationally recognized for its innovations in preschool education because of its enduring tradition of providing specialized professional training incorporated within a holistic music framework curriculum for children between the ages of three and six (Coppola et al., 2020; Jing, 2025; Watts, 2018; Yang & Welch, 2023).

Even with such an emphasis placed on fundamentals, there are gaps in preschool teaching functionality, specifically related to the effectiveness of the music curriculum. Concerns about current music theory, piano, vocal training, and children's music courses underscore a persistent disconnect between conceptual instruction and practical implementation in music education (Chen, 2024; Feldman et al., 2020; Gao, 2025). Many students feel inadequately prepared for teaching preschool-aged children music because they are not equipped to create and execute music lessons within actual preschool settings. Problems related to the neglect of multicultural music, modern teaching tools, and active teaching methods have widened the divide between the curriculum and current classroom demands (Barrett et al., 2022; Divyakala & Vasumathi, 2024; Kertz-Welzel, 2018; Webster & Williams, 2018). This is particularly concerning in the context where preschool educators are required to facilitate play-based learning using music that is innovative, diverse, developmentally appropriate, and supportive of holistic learning.

Conducting an educational analysis of the music course for preschool teacher education at Southwest University is the main goal of this investigation. This research aims to evaluate a preschool education curriculum's alignment with curriculum



design and instructional strategies by assessing the curriculum’s structure, teaching approaches, subject matter, and actual outcomes (Brenneman et al., 2019; Manire et al., 2023; Whitaker et al., 2022). This research, which includes document review, surveys, interviews, and program analysis, examines the degree to which frameworks—such as aesthetic, praxial, and multicultural music education—are integrated into the designs of educational programs and their enactment at the classroom level (An et al., 2025; Deterding & Waters, 2021; Liu & Chuangprakhon, 2024; Wang et al., 2025; Yan et al., 2025). Focus groups exploring students and instructors shed more light on the perceived advantages and disadvantages of the curriculum and their approaches to culture, creativity, skill advancement, and inclusivity.

The value of this particular study focuses on curriculum development policy at Southwest University and other affiliated teacher training universities. Considering the current expectations of fostering holistic, emotionally intelligent, and culturally aware individuals from a young age, it is crucial that music education shifts from being solely technical to an integrative component that adapts to the needs of educators. This particular research makes important contributions to educators' policymakers through the curriculum analytics framework by identifying existing gaps and opportunities in the curriculum. This research also emphasizes the need for programs aimed at preparing students for preschool teaching to harmonize instructional theory with applied skill development required to utilize music effectively in early childhood education.

2. Materials and Methods

This mixed methods research study included document analysis, structured interviews, and survey-based quantitative assessments ranging from Cole et al. (2019) to Uddin et al. (2023). It aimed to assess the music curriculum’s specifics during preschool teacher training from April 2023--May 2025 at Southwestern University. The comprehensive approach ensured an appropriate integration of data breadth and depth, which aided in forming insights into curriculum design, implementation, and effectiveness, such as curriculum perception, via interpretative evaluation.

2.1. Curriculum document analysis

The Master’s program documents for preschool education at Southwestern University (2018--2023) were accessed to gather information about the institutional music curriculum and its constituent courses. The guiding analysis targeted the distribution of credit hours to objectives, teaching strategies, and the balance of theory and practice. These documents served as music education benchmarks within the context of preschool teacher training as primary reference materials.

2.2. Interviews with key informants

The nine informants were selected for their direct participation in accentuating the music education aspects of preschool teachers. One group of informants consisted of instructors from the university, course trainers, and other staff from local kindergartens employing graduates of the program. The purpose of the interviews was to gain insights into the strengths of the provided curriculum, the challenges noted, and suggestions for change. The interviews were conducted, and their responses were recorded and transcribed and later analyzed via thematic coding to identify the relevant themes pertaining to pedagogical approaches, cultural relevance, and teacher readiness.

2.3. Survey of Participants

A questionnaire was given to 110 people, mostly students from the preschool education course and a few teaching staff, as a part of the structured survey. The survey assessed the level of satisfaction with the curriculum offered, the effectiveness of the teaching methods used, the amount of practical training, and the problems encountered during music training. The feedback was helpful for statistically determining the degree of correspondence between meeting curriculum expectations and overall learning needs, as shown in Table 1.

Table 1 Demographics of the survey respondents.

| Variable                  | Category          | Count | Percentage (%) |
|---------------------------|-------------------|-------|----------------|
| Gender                    | Female            | 98    | 89.1%          |
|                           | Male              | 12    | 10.9%          |
| Role                      | Student           | 102   | 92.7%          |
|                           | Teacher           | 8     | 7.3%           |
| Educational Qualification | Bachelor’s Degree | 95    | 86.4%          |
|                           | Master’s Degree   | 12    | 10.9%          |
|                           | Doctorate         | 3     | 2.7%           |
| Years of Experience       | 1–3 years         | 90    | 81.8%          |
|                           | 4–6 years         | 12    | 10.9%          |
|                           | Over 6 years      | 8     | 7.3%           |

## 2.4. Data analysis

The survey was analyzed through descriptive statistics, which enabled the measurement of satisfaction levels, the evaluation of curriculum concerns, and the categorization of teaching methods. Demographic data were also cross-tabulated with other variables to check for interrelationships. The qualitative interview data were analyzed thematically, starting with open coding to derive key concepts related to curriculum relevance, teaching effectiveness, and training inadequacies. The approaches were useful in assessing the music curriculum from both structural and experiential perspectives.

## 3. Results

The results from the document analysis, the interviews with nine informants and the survey involving 110 participants regarding the status and attributes of the music curriculum for preschool teacher training at Southwest University. The findings are organized into five key areas: curriculum structure and content, pedagogical methods, professional preparedness, practical theory, and evaluation of the proposed teaching model. In each subsection, a combination of quantitative and qualitative data is presented to provide a comprehensive view of the existing curriculum's advantages and disadvantages.

### 3.1. Curriculum structure and content

The music curriculum for preschool teachers training students at Southwest University has a sorely lacking prerequisite, such as music fundamentals, piano basics, children's music education, and vocal methods. These core components are designed to develop practical and theoretical musical skills; however, the curriculum structure poses a major challenge: music-related courses constitute only approximately 10% of the total academic workload. This limited percentage hampers the scope and depth of essential musical instruction, particularly for preschool educators in areas such as improvisation, songwriting, and activity teaching design.

The evidence collected from interviews with faculty and employer informants confirms that this percentage is inadequate for equipping prospective teachers with the competence to integrate music into early childhood education. One instructor expressed that the limited amount of time allocated to music education results in only teaching fundamental skills. This is what the data from other surveys also indicate, as shown in Figure 1, overwhelmingly supports the claim that 81.8% believed that the curriculum inadequately served their needs. Full satisfaction was indicated by 9.1%, whereas another 9.1% claimed that there was no unmet need at all.

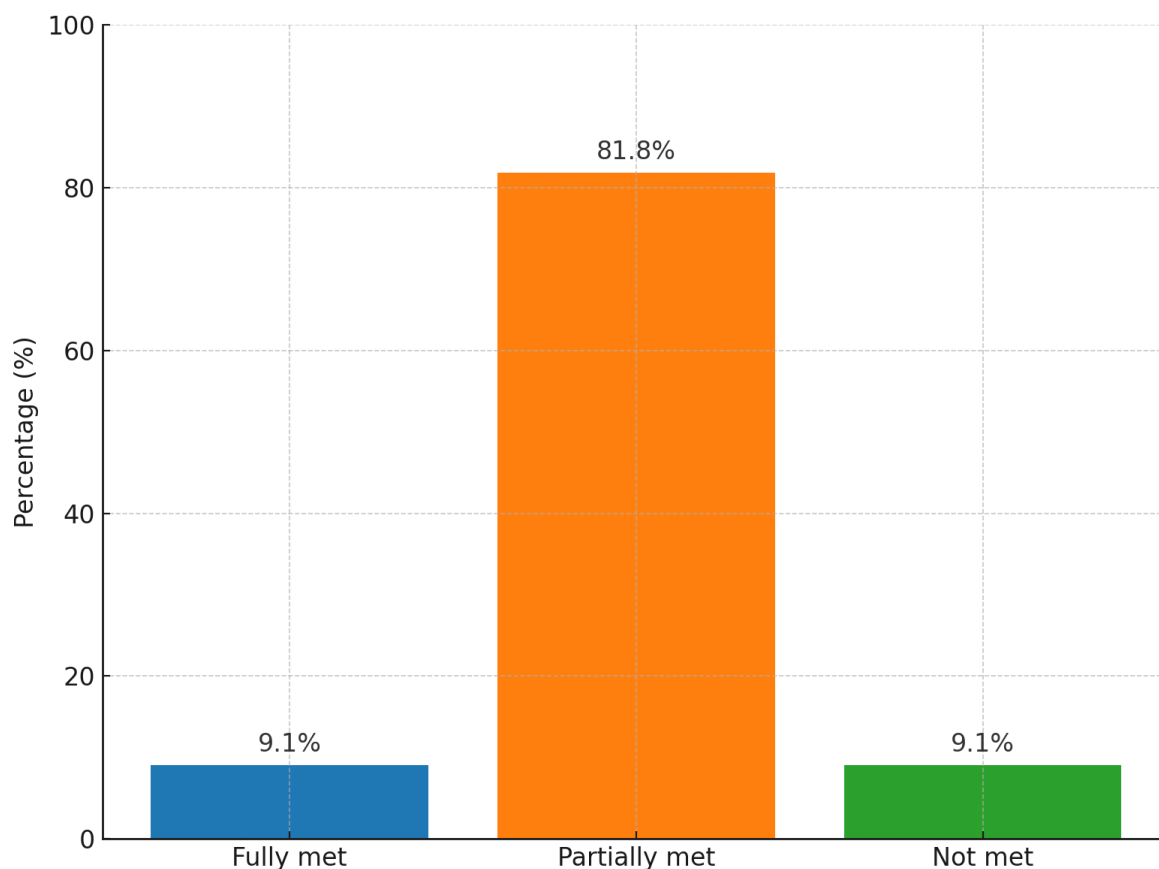


Figure 1 Curriculum satisfaction levels.

Further analysis of the course syllabi and credit allocation shown in Figure 2 reinforces the perception of disproportionate balance. The offered courses focus primarily on the underlying theory, leaving little or no room for practical application that involves teaching through peer teaching, teaching practice, or interdisciplinary teaching. Several students stated in the interviews that although they were grateful for having received instruction in music theory and piano, they were highly unable to create lesson plans or perform songs within a pretended preschool classroom.

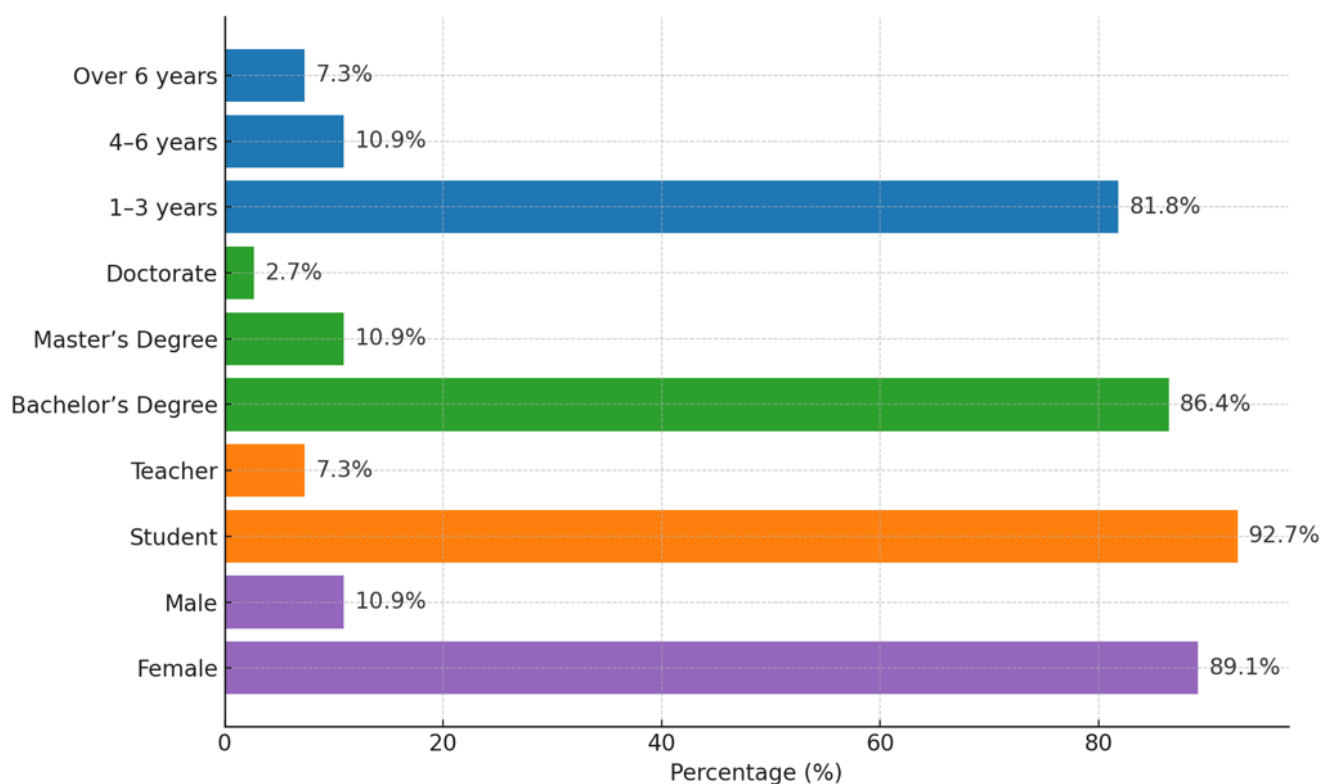


Figure 2 Demographics of the survey respondents.

The gap between curriculum content and competencies results in graduates having knowledge without the applied confidence needed to teach using music as a taught subject. Therefore, music-related coursework needs to be balanced to pay more attention to practical integration with early childhood milestones.

### 3.2. Pedagogical approaches

The music curriculum for preschool teacher training in Southwest China is based on the two most important aspects of aesthetic music education and praxial music education. The first one was developed by Bennett Reimer and focuses on students who appreciate music deeply. The latter is propounded by David Elliott and focuses on learning music through practicing it—performing, improvising and creating music.

The implementation of these frameworks in practice remains inconsistent despite their strong theoretical underpinnings. Faculty interviews indicate an understanding of the need for equilibrium between emotional participation and active engagement—however, current practices remain predominantly teacher dominated and lecturing. The observations of music classes corroborated the underutilization of many active teaching methods, collaborative group work, student self-reflective dialog, and the emotional and practical internalization of music education.

The survey results also reinforce this gap. As shown in Figure 3, almost one-third of the respondents, 43.6% and 40.9%, respectively, still preferred practicality (Prac) and cultivating interest (FostInt) as their primary approaches to teaching in their profession, even though 61.8% of the participants supported a balanced approach emphasizing practice and theory (BalPT). This indicates an increased shift toward more active and constructive student-centered teaching. However, 31.8% of the studies focusing on instrumental skill development (InstrSk) suggest that despite valuing technical skills, there needs to be an anchored depth in pedagogical and emotional intelligence in early childhood frameworks.

An informant noted that the curriculum is “musically rich but pedagogically narrow,” emphasizing a central problem: students are able to perform music, yet they risk graduating without effective teaching methodologies or self-assurance to instruct young children in the subject. This reveals a marked deficiency in pedagogical training within teaching frameworks that rely too heavily on Elliott's praxial philosophy.

Another issue is a lack of digital tools and educational technology, which is exacerbated by the very modern aids that students are not exposed to, such as music education apps, digital composition programs, or online collaborative workspaces. This gap diminishes the relevance of the curriculum in contemporary preschool settings, where structured, multiresource interactive learning is becoming the new standard.

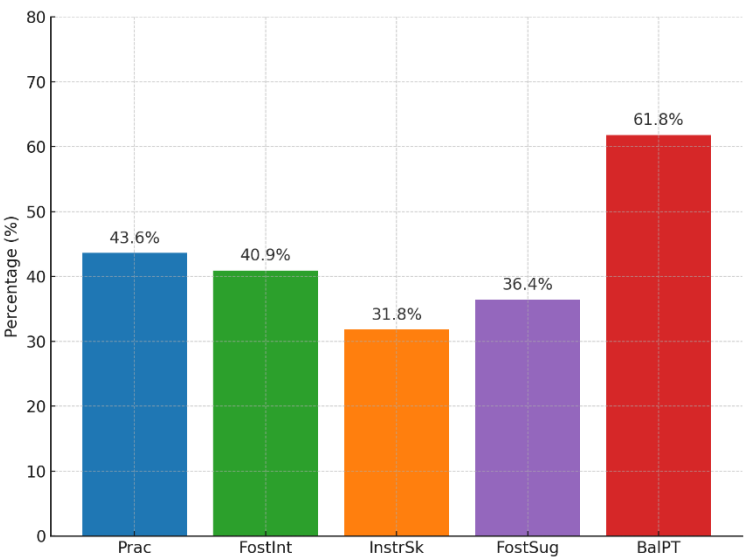


Figure 3 Survey respondents’ priorities and preferences.

3.3. Practical and professional readiness

Southwest University faculty and students raised one of the most critical issues regarding the lack of practical training integrated into the preschool music curriculum. As shown in Figure 4, over half of the survey participants (50.9%) highlighted practical teaching as the most challenging component of their education. This comment illustrates the perceived lack of bridging connecting theory with practical elements of classroom teaching.

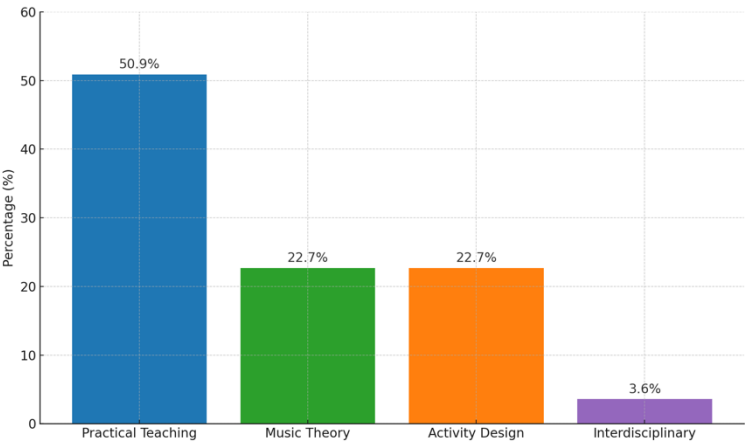


Figure 4 Insufficient practical training.

Students often complained that their internships were too short and poorly organized. Many of these practical components do not include opportunities to teach in real preschool classrooms, thus severely restricting students’ exposure to child-centered teaching paradigms. Faculty interviews confirmed this, with the instructors pointing out that the current models of the internship program do not provide adequate structure or range in regard to nurturing practical skills in music teaching.

In addition, employer comments noted that many new graduates still have difficulty adjusting music lessons for preschool children. Some used adult-centered strategies or one-size-fits-all approaches that were irrelevant to the children’s level of thinking and feelings. This finding highlights insufficient professional preparedness as well as the absence of appropriate attempts to integrate music training and early childhood teaching aims.

Students and faculty alike expressed concern over the lack of self-confidence in implementing music-based classroom activities. Some students voiced strong levels of discomfort in using music as a medium for emotional or therapeutic



expression, which is fundamental in early childhood education. This calls for an urgent response in the form of professional development that blends music instruction with social-emotional development frameworks.

Furthermore, the lack of emphasis placed on multicultural music within the curriculum prevents students from being able to construct holistic learning settings. Every preschool graduate needs to be able to access a variety of global music and contemporary cultural appreciation, awareness, and foster awareness toward fostering children.

In combination, all of this evidence suggests that structural revisions of balance redundancy internships, curriculum practicum placements, and spanning work definitions should include. Scaffolding mentorships, increasing the length of placements, multicultural content and systems stem from their frameworks, including phenomenology, and empirical critical inclusivism, equip future instructors with pedagogical competencies to interact with complex tasks with diverse populations through songs. The findings also suggest that education related to child theocratic development should be comprehensive and responsive to the holistic, integrated, and emotionally considerate nature of preschool children to teach nurtured school children of that age.

### *3.4. Bridging the gap between music theory and pedagogical practice*

Here, the issue is the gap between theoretical understanding and practical execution, which was also noted during the interviews. The difficulty in applying music theory concepts to lessons comes as no surprise, given that 22.7% of the participants reported facing difficulties with music theory itself, and an equal number of participants noted complications with devising music-related teaching activities. This pattern suggests a gap between comprehending music fundamentally and formulating effective teaching methods to communicate that understanding.

The faculty interviews provide a clearer context for this issue. The core problem seems to be the persistent theoretical–practical dichotomy. The teaching of music theory focuses on its constituent elements, such as note names and rhythms, scales and intervals, in complete silence. Instructions on how to integrate these elements into early childhood teaching are never provided. One instructor bluntly stated, “Students can name intervals and rhythms, but can’t explain how to teach these to preschoolers.”

This explanation was corroborated by the students. While training, they are guided to sing a number of songs and play the piano, but few are trained to prepare lesson plans incorporating these activities or child-centered musical tasks. This inconsistency between what learners are taught and how they are expected to teach in actual classrooms results in conceptual fragmentation and a deficit in practical self-efficacy.

In closing this gap, faculty and students proposed a shift toward more applied and interdisciplinary approaches. For example, theory lessons could incorporate lesson plan development, which includes role-playing, peer-teaching, and reflective practice, through simulations. Moreover, collaboration between instructors from different courses enhances coherence and cohesive alignment by offering constructive guidance on how to apply teaching theory, practice, and teaching objectives. Addressing this gap is crucial for developing the ability of preschool teacher students to meaningfully contextualize music theory in various educational settings.

### *3.5. Feedback on the teaching model*

As a starting point for possible curriculum restructuring, participants were asked to provide feedback on a conjectural music teaching model aligned with the framework of combining practical and theoretical elements. The feedback was overwhelmingly positive. In Figure 3, 65.5% of the respondents reported watching a very significant impact on professional development, and another 29.1% reported watching a moderate impact. These responses underscore the need for more integrated, hands-on training approaches in preschool teacher education programs.

The participants particularly appreciated the model's focus on applied learning, which included classroom simulations as well as practical teaching of music. The interview data revealed that students were most excited about incorporating collaborative work, improvisation, and self-evaluation into the curriculum. They believed these elements would help them integrate the concepts of knowing and teaching music to young children. Some participants suggested that coteaching or assistant teaching during the internship could be useful in preparing them for real classroom situations.

The participants also appreciated the emphasis on formative assessment in the model. Students welcomed the concept of feedback in the form of journals, peer reviews, and teacher evaluations. These tools were viewed as important both for the development of skills and for pedagogical practices.

Faculty interviews also supported the broader application of the model. A number of instructors remark that the combination of technical skills with cultural and emotional aspects makes the model suitable for current preschool education practices. They were willing to test the model at Southwest University, proposing it as a candidate for curriculum enhancement in other teacher education institutions in China.

In conclusion, the participant feedback analysis indicates that the proposed teaching model meets the current needs of curriculum design and helps address the gap in the development of capable, self-assured, and culturally aware preschool music educators through responsive system design.

#### 4. Discussion

These results provide profound information regarding the planning, execution, and evaluation of the preschool music curriculum at Southwest University. According to our findings, the curriculum features certain primary elements, including music fundamentals, piano basics, and children's music pedagogy; however, the curriculum's scope is lacking, and its primary focus is theoretical, which greatly diminishes its value for the actual preparation of educators. These findings corroborate earlier research that has pointed out similar issues in the field of early childhood music pedagogy, especially within frameworks that lack a robust practical component to accompany the theoretical content offered (Chen, 2024; Barrett et al., 2022).

The lack of practical training was highlighted by both the interviews and the surveys, suggesting that it is a persistent theme. Participants struggled with bridging the gap between theory and practice, and Webster and Williams (2018) argued that effective music education integrates technology, creativity, and contextually applicable pedagogy, which breaches the curriculum's aesthetic and praxial (Reimer and Elliott) underpinnings. Although, in theory, the curriculum follows the aesthetic (Reimer) and praxial (Elliott) frameworks, in practice, it is still attempting to 'figure out' how to fully implement these models. For example, aesthetic education encourages active emotional engagement with music, yet the participants did not feel equipped to facilitate music experience emotionally in children. In addition, while praxial theory focuses on music-making as the core of learning (Elliott, 1995), students were mostly passive participants in the lecture style of teaching. There was no performance, improvisation, or reflective pedagogy.

The findings also demonstrate a gap between what is taught in the curriculum and the developmental stages of preschool children. Most participants expressed discomfort around the design of class-appropriate music activities because of a lack of exposure to child-focused pedagogical approaches. This finding supports Mugaya's (2022) claim that music in early childhood should be grounded in experience and culturally relevant. Kertz-Welzel's (2018) and Coppola et al.'s (2020) critique of the curriculum's insufficient multicultural music and digital technology integration is still troubling. With increasing global preschool education standards focusing on inclusivity innovation (Whitaker et al., 2022), these examples highlight gaps within contemporary educational frameworks.

Students' and faculty's comments regarding the proposed teaching model were especially revealing. Almost all the students and faculty participants strongly endorsed a shift toward a practice-based model that included simulations, cooperative teaching, improvisation, and formative evaluation. These preferences support contemporary work that advocates for action reflection, participation, and an interdisciplinary approach to teacher education (Gallant & Luthy, 2020; An et al., 2025). Partti et al. (2021) focus on music education technology as a propeller of instructional engagement and teacher readiness, which reinforces the model's focus on applied learning.

In summary, the curriculum of Southwest China clearly devotes to fostering music education; however, there is a dire need for reform to address modern educational frameworks. It is critical to shift the balance between practical and theoretical components, deepen the digital and multicultural aspects, and reframe internships into active teaching mentorship programs. Such changes are critical for enhancing teaching practices and for empowering trainees to use music as a transformative tool in early childhood education.

Future work should include longitudinal designs to evaluate how changes in the curriculum influence teaching effectiveness among graduates in actual teaching scenarios. Additionally, cross-institutional comparisons might be helpful in identifying effective approaches for training preschool music teachers. Moreover, action research encompassing pilot curricula and collaborative teaching models could address these gaps and provide useful solutions for broader implementation.

#### 5. Final Considerations

The research findings fulfilled the set research objective: the current curriculum with an underlying aesthetic and praxial framework does not prepare students for the diverse, child-friendly, and interdisciplinary approaches required in contemporary preschool music teaching. Document analysis, participant surveys, and expert interviews revealed a consistent absence of adequate applied learning opportunities, limited multicultural components, and scant use of contemporary educational technologies. These factors impede professional readiness and self-efficacy concerning the use of music instruction as a pedagogical tool. At the same time, however, considerable evidence supporting the revised model focused on experiential learning, team teaching, and reflective practice illustrates a way forward. This research contributes to curriculum innovations that develop benchmarks for holistic benchmarks and international best practices in early childhood education. The case study of one university, combined with an exclusively self-reported participant dataset, has limitations; however, the incorporated triangulation of methodologies adds credibility and other perspectives. Addressing curriculum change with a longitudinal approach, expanding the institutional scope of the study, and analyzing the inclusion of digital and culturally relevant materials offer promising directions for future work in preschool music teacher education. This illustrates a notable contribution toward the discourse surrounding music education in initial teacher education, advocating for comprehensive approaches that advance practicality and inclusiveness.

#### Ethical Considerations

The study adhered to ethical research standards as required by institutional and national regulations. All participants provided informed consent before participation. The identities of the nine key informants were anonymized to maintain confidentiality. The data collected were securely stored and used exclusively for research purposes. No personal information was disclosed, and participants had the right to withdraw from the study at any stage without consequence.

### Conflict of Interest

The authors declare that they have no conflicts of interest.

### Funding

This research did not receive any financial support.

### References

- An, N., Chuangprakhon, S., Seekhunlio, W., & Liu, Q. (2025). Guqin transmission in the digital age: A posthumanist perspective on music education. *Journal of Posthumanism*, 5(2), 771–783. <https://doi.org/10.63332/joph.v5i2.453>
- Barrett, J. S., Schachter, R. E., Gilbert, D., & Fuerst, M. (2022). Best practices for preschool music education: Supporting music-making throughout the day. *Early Childhood Education Journal*, 50(3), 385–397. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10643-021-01155-8>
- Brenneman, K., Lange, A., & Nayfeld, I. (2019). Integrating STEM into preschool education: Designing a professional development model in diverse settings. *Early Childhood Education Journal*, 47, 15–28. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10643-018-0912-z>
- Chen, Y. (2024). Effective strategies and methods to enhance music practical teaching in higher vocational preschool education. *Pacific International Journal*, 7(1), 162–167. <https://doi.org/10.55014/pij.v7i1.545>
- Cole, D., Kitchen, J. A., & Kezar, A. (2019). Examining a comprehensive college transition program: An account of iterative mixed methods longitudinal survey design. *Research in Higher Education*, 60, 392–413. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11162-018-9515-1>
- Coppola, W. J., Hebert, D. G., & Campbell, P. S. (2020). *World music pedagogy, volume VII: Teaching world music in higher education*. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780429278617>
- Deterding, N. M., & Waters, M. C. (2021). Flexible coding of in-depth interviews: A twenty-first-century approach. *Sociological Methods & Research*, 50(2), 708–739. <https://doi.org/10.1177/0049124118799377>
- Divyakala, C., & Vasumathi, A. (2024). Tracing the threads: A bibliometric exploration of workplace bullying, psychological well-being, and employee performance. *Multidisciplinary Reviews*, 7(3), 2024056. <https://doi.org/10.31893/multirev.2024056>
- Elliott, D. J. (1995). *Music matters: A new philosophy of music education*. Oxford University Press.
- Feldman, E., Lutch, M., Contzius, A., & Bugaj, K. (2020). *Instrumental music education: Teaching with the musical and practical in harmony*. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9780429028700>
- Gallant, D. J., & Luthy, N. (2020). Mixed methods research in designing an instrument for consumer-oriented evaluation. *Journal of Multidisciplinary Evaluation*, 16(34), 21–43. <https://doi.org/10.56645/jmde.v16i34.583>
- Gao, G. (2025). Teaching methods and strategies that integrate cultural ideas in piano education: Exploration from a global perspective. *Cultura: International Journal of Philosophy of Culture and Axiology*, 22(4), 642–658.
- Jing, Z. (2025). The evolution, present practices, and future directions of early childhood education and care in China. *European Journal of Education*, 60(1), e12880. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ejed.12880>
- Kertz-Welzel, A. (2018). *Globalizing music education: A framework*. Indiana University Press. <https://doi.org/10.2307/j.ctt2204p3c>
- Liu, S., & Chuangprakhon, S. (2024). Reviewing the current situation of Huadengxi Chinese folk songs in Yunnan Province. *Multidisciplinary Reviews*, 7(5), 2024109. <https://doi.org/10.31893/multirev.2024109>
- Manire, E., Kilag, O. K., Habig, M., Satin, R., Genovania, M. R., & Tan, S. J. (2023). A technological approach to early childhood education: Unveiling the SEEDS pedagogy. *Excellencia: International Multi-disciplinary Journal of Education (2994-9521)*, 1(5), 333–344.
- Mugaya, T. S. (2022). Music in early childhood education: Its importance in child development and classroom interaction. *International Journal of Educational Policy Research and Review*, 9(4), 97–103. <https://doi.org/10.15739/IJEPRR.22.011>
- Music, G. (2024). *Nurturing natures: Attachment and children's emotional, sociocultural and brain development*. Routledge. <https://doi.org/10.4324/9781003368151>
- Partti, H., Weber, J., & Rolle, C. (2021). Learning a skill, or learning to learn? Supporting teachers' professional development in music education technology. *Journal of Music, Technology & Education*, 14(2–3), 123–139. [https://doi.org/10.1386/jmte\\_00037\\_1](https://doi.org/10.1386/jmte_00037_1)
- Segarra-Ciprés, M., Escrig-Tena, A. B., & García-Juan, B. (2020). The link between quality management and innovation performance: A content analysis of survey-based research. *Total Quality Management & Business Excellence*, 31(1–2), 1–22. <https://doi.org/10.1080/14783363.2017.1401460>
- Shlenova, M., Yuryeva, K., Heletka, M., Kravchenko, Y., & Kravchenko, V. (2025). Distance learning in Ukrainian higher education as an aspect of the industrial revolution 4.0. *Multidisciplinary Reviews*, 8(4), 2025102. <https://doi.org/10.31893/multirev.2025102>
- Uddin, N., Zaman, M., & Fayaz, S. A. (2023). Data gaps, tenuity and measurement challenges in achieving sustainable maternal child healthcare ecosystem: An evidence based statistical evaluation. *Multidisciplinary Reviews*, 6(3), 2023024. <https://doi.org/10.31893/multirev.2023024>
- Wang, H., Jamali, S. S. B., & Muhid, S. H. B. (2025). Fusion and innovation: Exploring the application and effects of the Italian Bel Canto technique in enhancing the expressiveness of Chinese national vocal performance. *Multidisciplinary Reviews*, 8(2). <https://doi.org/10.31893/multirev.2025065>
- Wang, X., Chuangprakhon, S., Jian, S., & Wang, G. (2024). Educational resources and instructional approaches for Chinese Hua'er folk songs in Gansu and Ningxia. *Journal of Education and Learning (EduLearn)*, 18(3), 914–922. <https://doi.org/10.11591/edulearn.v18i3.21589>
- Watts, S. H. (2018). *World music pedagogy, Volume I: Early childhood education*. Routledge.

- Webster, P. R., & Williams, D. B. (2018). Technology's role for achieving creativity, diversity and integration in the American undergraduate music curriculum: Some theoretical, historical and practical perspectives. *Journal of Music, Technology & Education*, 11(1), 5–36. [https://doi.org/10.1386/jmte.11.1.5\\_1](https://doi.org/10.1386/jmte.11.1.5_1)
- Whitaker, A. A., Jenkins, J. M., & Duer, J. K. (2022). Standards, curriculum, and assessment in early childhood education: Examining alignment across multiple state systems. *Early Childhood Research Quarterly*, 58, 59–74. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecresq.2021.07.008>
- Wu, W. C., Yang, C. H., & Turner, M. (2023). Exploring the interdisciplinary relationship between music and language for enhanced bilingual curriculum. *Journal of Curriculum Studies Research*, 5(3), 96–112. <https://doi.org/10.46303/jcsr.2023.33>
- Yan, L., Chuangprakhon, S., Seekhunlio, W., & Liu, Q. (2025). Posthuman aesthetics and indigenous knowledge: Elunchun folk songs in contemporary music education. *Journal of Posthumanism*, 5(3), 1139–1150. <https://doi.org/10.63332/joph.v5i3.859>
- Yang, Y., & Welch, G. (2023). A systematic literature review of Chinese music education studies during 2007 to 2019. *International Journal of Music Education*, 41(2), 175–198. <https://doi.org/10.1177/02557614221096150>